

## Module 6

### Q. Business use of Social Media - Measuring success, Interaction and monitoring, case study.

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#### 1. Meaning of Business Use of Social Media

- Businesses use social media platforms to promote products, communicate with customers, and improve brand awareness.
- Social media helps organizations connect directly with their target audience.
- Businesses use platforms such as Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn, and YouTube for marketing and communication.
- Social media supports customer service, advertising, sales, and brand building.
- It allows businesses to reach large audiences at a lower cost compared to traditional advertising.
- For example, a small business can promote its products through Instagram reels and Facebook advertisements.

#### Measuring Success in Social Media

##### 1. Importance of Measuring Success

- Businesses must measure the success of their social media activities to understand whether their goals are being achieved.
- Measuring success helps identify which campaigns are effective and which need improvement.
- It supports better decision making and future planning.
- Businesses use different metrics and KPIs to evaluate performance.
- Regular monitoring improves return on investment from social media.
- For example, a company may compare the performance of two advertising campaigns to see which one generated more sales.

##### 2. Common Metrics Used

- Reach measures how many people saw a post or advertisement.
- Engagement measures how users interact through likes, comments, shares, and clicks.
- Follower growth measures the increase in audience over time.
- Conversion rate measures how many users completed a desired action such as making a purchase.
- Click-through rate measures how many users clicked on a link or advertisement.
- For example, a business may track the number of people who clicked on an Instagram advertisement and visited its website.

### **3. Return on Investment (ROI)**

- ROI measures the value gained from social media activities compared to the money spent.
- Businesses compare revenue generated from campaigns with the advertising cost.
- A positive ROI indicates that the campaign was successful.
- ROI helps businesses decide whether they should continue or change their strategy.
- Measuring ROI is important for effective budgeting and planning.
- For example, a company spending ₹10,000 on Facebook ads and earning ₹50,000 in sales achieves a positive ROI.

## **Interaction and Monitoring**

### **1. Customer Interaction**

- Social media allows businesses to interact directly with customers.
- Customers can ask questions, give feedback, and share complaints through comments and messages.
- Quick responses improve customer satisfaction and trust.
- Interaction helps businesses build strong relationships with their audience.
- Businesses can also use polls, contests, and live sessions to increase engagement.
- For example, a brand may reply to customer comments on Instagram to answer product-related questions.

### **2. Monitoring Brand Reputation**

- Businesses monitor social media to understand how customers feel about their brand.
- Monitoring helps identify positive and negative comments quickly.
- Businesses can respond to complaints before they become serious problems.
- Monitoring also helps detect fake news or misleading information.
- Social listening tools help businesses track mentions, hashtags, and customer opinions.
- For example, companies monitor Twitter to identify complaints about product quality or service issues.

### **3. Competitor Monitoring**

- Businesses also monitor the activities of competitors on social media.
- Competitor monitoring helps identify successful campaigns and new trends.
- Companies can learn from competitor strengths and weaknesses.
- This helps businesses improve their own strategies and remain competitive.
- Monitoring competitors also helps identify gaps in the market.
- For example, a restaurant may study how competitor restaurants promote special offers on Instagram.

## **Case Study: Starbucks**

- Starbucks uses social media platforms such as Facebook, Instagram, and Twitter to connect with customers.
- The company regularly posts product updates, seasonal drinks, offers, and customer stories.
- Starbucks encourages customers to share photos of their drinks and use branded hashtags.
- This increases customer engagement and brand visibility.
- Starbucks also interacts with customers by replying to comments and complaints on social media.
- The company monitors customer feedback to improve products and services.
- Starbucks uses social media analytics to understand which campaigns perform best.
- Seasonal campaigns such as holiday drinks often receive high engagement.
- The company also uses social media to promote loyalty programs and mobile app offers.
- As a result, Starbucks has built a strong online presence and loyal customer community.

## **Q. Privacy and threats - Privacy policies and maintaining privacy online.**

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### **1. Meaning of Privacy in Social Media**

- Privacy refers to the protection of personal information shared on social media and online platforms.
- Users share data such as names, photos, locations, contact details, and opinions on social media.
- Privacy helps ensure that this information is not misused by others.
- Maintaining privacy is important for personal safety and security.
- Businesses also need to protect customer and employee information.
- For example, keeping account passwords and personal details private helps prevent misuse.

### **2. Meaning of Threats**

- Threats are dangers or risks that can affect the privacy and security of users online.
- Threats may come from hackers, fake accounts, malware, phishing, or data leaks.
- Social media users can become victims of identity theft or fraud.
- Businesses can also face security risks if confidential information is exposed.
- Online threats can damage reputation, finances, and personal safety.
- For example, a hacker stealing login credentials from a social media account is a security threat.

## **Privacy Policies**

### **1. Meaning of Privacy Policy**

- A privacy policy is a document that explains how a website or platform collects, uses, and protects user data.
- Privacy policies inform users about what information is collected from them.
- They also explain how the collected data is stored and shared.
- Businesses and social media platforms use privacy policies to build trust with users.
- Users should read privacy policies before sharing information online.
- For example, social media platforms explain how they use profile information, photos, and location data.

### **2. Importance of Privacy Policies**

- Privacy policies help users understand their rights regarding personal data.
- They inform users whether their data will be shared with third parties.
- Privacy policies help businesses follow legal and ethical requirements.
- They improve transparency between organizations and users.
- Proper privacy policies reduce the risk of misuse of personal information.

- For example, users may decide not to use an app if its privacy policy allows excessive data sharing.

### **3. Common Contents of Privacy Policies**

- Privacy policies usually describe what type of data is collected.
- They explain how data is used for advertising, analytics, or customer service.
- Privacy policies may mention whether cookies and tracking technologies are used.
- They also explain how users can manage or delete their information.
- Some policies describe how long data will be stored.
- For example, a website may mention that it stores browsing history for six months.

## **Maintaining Privacy Online**

### **1. Using Strong Passwords**

- Users should create strong passwords for social media and online accounts.
- Strong passwords should contain letters, numbers, and special symbols.
- Passwords should not be shared with others.
- Different accounts should have different passwords.
- Strong passwords reduce the risk of hacking.
- For example, a password such as “Abc@12345” is safer than “123456”.

### **2. Enabling Two-Factor Authentication**

- Two-factor authentication provides an extra layer of security.
- It requires users to enter an additional verification code along with the password.
- This makes it more difficult for hackers to access accounts.
- Many social media platforms provide two-factor authentication options.
- Users should enable this feature for important accounts.
- For example, a code sent to a mobile phone can be used for login verification.

### **3. Limiting Personal Information Sharing**

- Users should avoid sharing too much personal information online.
- Details such as phone numbers, addresses, and bank information should remain private.
- Oversharing personal details increases privacy risks.
- Users should be careful while posting photos, travel plans, or personal routines.
- Limiting information sharing helps improve online safety.
- For example, users should avoid posting their exact home address on social media.

### **4. Adjusting Privacy Settings**

- Social media platforms provide privacy settings to control who can view posts and information.

- Users should review and update privacy settings regularly.
- Privacy settings can limit profile visibility to selected people.
- Users can control who can comment, message, or tag them.
- Proper privacy settings help reduce unwanted access to personal information.
- For example, setting a Facebook profile to “Friends Only” increases privacy.

## **5. Avoiding Suspicious Links and Messages**

- Users should avoid clicking unknown links or messages from strangers.
- Suspicious links may contain malware or phishing attacks.
- Fake messages may ask for passwords or personal information.
- Users should verify the source before opening links.
- Being careful online reduces the risk of fraud and hacking.
- For example, an email asking for bank details may be a phishing attempt.

## **Q. Benefits of Social Media in Content Creation and Different Fields/Sectors**

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### **1. Benefits of Social Media in Content Creation**

- Social media provides a platform for creators to share content with a large audience.
- Content creators can publish videos, photos, blogs, reels, podcasts, and live sessions.
- Social media helps creators receive instant feedback through likes, comments, and shares.
- It allows creators to understand what type of content is popular among audiences.
- Social media supports creativity because creators can experiment with different formats and styles.
- It also helps creators build a personal brand and gain followers.
- For example, creators on YouTube can earn revenue through ads and sponsorships.

### **2. Benefits in Business and Marketing**

- Social media helps businesses promote products and services at a lower cost.
- Companies can reach large audiences through advertisements and organic posts.
- Businesses can interact directly with customers and receive feedback quickly.
- Social media supports brand awareness and customer loyalty.
- Companies can use targeted advertising to reach specific groups of users.
- For example, Instagram is widely used by fashion brands to showcase products and attract customers.

### **3. Benefits in Education**

- Social media helps students and teachers share educational content easily.
- Educational institutions use social media to provide announcements, notes, and learning materials.
- Students can join groups and communities to discuss topics and solve doubts.
- Social media supports online learning through videos, tutorials, and webinars.
- Teachers can interact with students outside the classroom.
- For example, educational videos on YouTube help students learn programming, mathematics, and science.

### **4. Benefits in Healthcare**

- Social media helps spread awareness about diseases, health issues, and treatments.
- Hospitals and doctors use social media to share health tips and important information.
- Patients can connect with healthcare professionals through online platforms.
- Social media supports public health campaigns and awareness programs.
- Healthcare organizations can quickly share updates during emergencies or disease outbreaks.
- For example, hospitals use Facebook to share vaccination schedules and health guidelines.

## **5. Benefits in Entertainment**

- Social media helps actors, singers, and creators promote movies, songs, and events.
- Entertainment companies use social media to engage fans and create excitement before releases.
- Users can watch trailers, music videos, and live streams online.
- Social media makes it easier for artists to connect directly with fans.
- Viral trends and challenges often help entertainment content become more popular.
- For example, songs promoted on TikTok often become popular worldwide.

## **6. Benefits in Politics and Government**

- Social media helps political leaders communicate directly with the public.
- Governments use social media to share policies, announcements, and emergency information.
- Political campaigns use social media to reach voters and spread messages.
- Social media encourages public participation and discussion about important issues.
- Citizens can give feedback to government departments through social media.
- For example, government agencies use Twitter to provide updates about public services.

## **7. Benefits in Tourism and Travel**

- Social media helps tourism companies promote destinations, hotels, and travel packages.
- Travelers share photos, videos, and reviews about places they visit.
- Social media helps people discover new travel destinations and experiences.
- Hotels and travel agencies use social media advertisements to attract customers.
- Travel influencers play an important role in promoting tourism.
- For example, scenic travel reels on Instagram encourage people to visit new places.

## **8. Benefits in Employment and Recruitment**

- Social media helps job seekers and employers connect with each other.
- Companies use social media to post job openings and recruit candidates.
- Professionals use social media to build networks and showcase skills.
- Social media supports personal branding for career growth.
- Recruiters can identify suitable candidates through online profiles.
- For example, LinkedIn is widely used for job search and professional networking.

## **9. Benefits in Customer Service**

- Social media allows businesses to respond quickly to customer questions and complaints.
- Customers can contact companies through comments, direct messages, and posts.
- Quick support improves customer satisfaction and trust.
- Businesses can monitor customer feedback and improve services.
- Social media makes customer service more convenient and accessible.

- For example, airlines often use Twitter to handle customer complaints and travel updates.

## **10. Benefits in Social Awareness**

- Social media helps spread awareness about social issues and public campaigns.
- Organizations use social media to educate people about important causes.
- Social media supports fundraising, charity events, and volunteer activities.
- Awareness campaigns can reach millions of people quickly.
- Social media encourages people to participate in social change.
- For example, campaigns related to environmental protection often become popular on social media platforms.